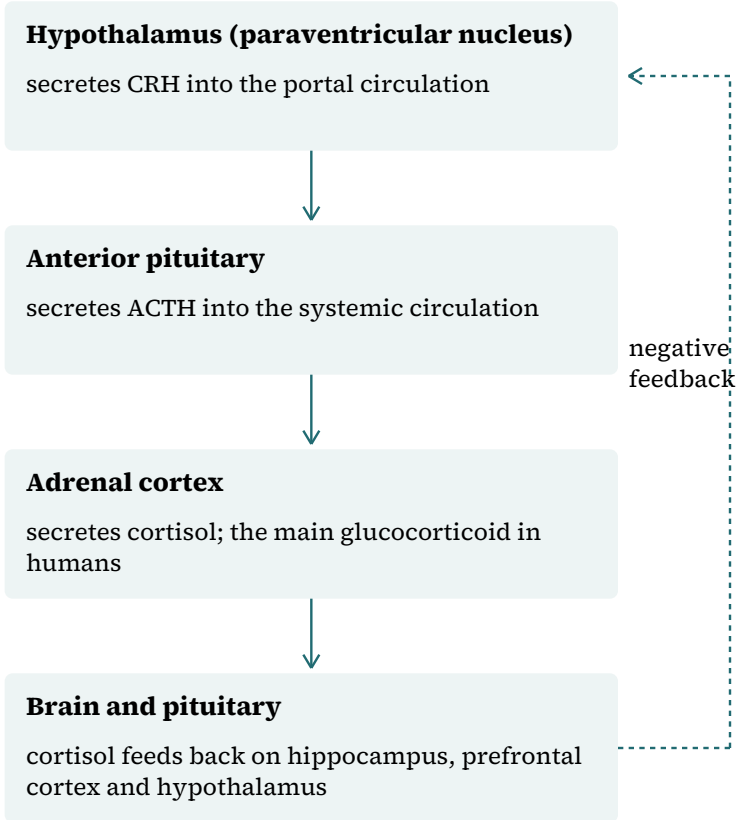
Hypothalamus (paraventricular nucleus)
secretes CRH into the portal circulation
Anterior pituitary
secretes ACTH into the systemic circulation
Adrenal cortex
secretes cortisol; the main glucocorticoid in humans
Brain and pituitary
cortisol feeds back on hippocampus, prefrontal cortex and hypothalamus
negative feedback